

I'll keep the full-family sweep rather than treating **risk** as only "danger." The reference's broad-family method is especially important here because **risk** has major independent branches in everyday English, business, insurance, finance, medicine, epidemiology, engineering, law, project management, and statistics.

**Word family: risk / risks / risked / risking /
risky / riskily / riskiness / risk-free /
risk-based / at-risk / high-risk / low-risk /
risk-taking / risk-taker / de-risk / de-risking**

Base word: risk

Plural: risks

Past tense: risked

Past participle: risked

-ing form: risking

Major related forms:

- risky
- riskiness
- riskily — uncommon
- risk-free
- risk-based
- risk-adjusted
- risk-sensitive
- risk-averse
- risk-neutral
- risk-seeking
- risk-taking
- risk-taker
- at-risk
- high-risk
- low-risk
- de-risk / derisk
- de-risking / derisking

Major constructions/extensions:

- risk of
- risk that

- at risk
- at risk of
- put/place someone at risk
- take a risk
- run a risk
- run the risk of
- risk doing something
- risk one's life
- risk everything
- risk it
- at your own risk
- at the risk of sounding...
- calculated risk
- risk factor
- risk assessment
- risk management
- risk mitigation
- risk appetite
- risk tolerance
- risk aversion
- risk profile
- risk exposure
- risk premium
- risk-free rate
- risk-adjusted return
- value at risk
- risk-on / risk-off
- credit risk
- market risk
- liquidity risk
- operational risk
- insurance risk
- medical risk
- relative risk
- absolute risk
- project risk
- security risk
- assumption of risk

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your passage:

“...a café dream shared with friends, full of freedom, **risk** and possibility.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **risk** means the possibility that opening the café could lead to undesirable outcomes such as financial loss, business failure, debt, conflict, or career difficulty.

繁體中文：

- 風險
- 可能遭受損失／失敗的不確定性
- 承擔失敗後果的可能

A natural interpretation is:

“full of freedom, **risk** and possibility”

「充滿自由、風險與可能性」

The writer deliberately pairs:

possibility = positive uncertainty

risk = negative uncertainty.

A. RISK = POSSIBILITY OF HARM OR LOSS

1. risk = possibility that something bad may happen (風險)

The central noun sense.

“There is a risk of failure.”

「存在失敗的風險。」

“Every business involves some risk.”

「每門生意都涉及一定程度的風險。」

The key idea is:

bad outcome is **possible**, not certain.

2. risk of + noun / -ing

A major grammar pattern.

“There is a risk of financial loss.”

「有財務損失的風險。」

“You risk losing your savings.”

Related verb pattern discussed later.

3. risk that + clause

“There is a risk that the café will fail.”

「存在咖啡店經營失敗的風險。」

B. RISK = DEGREE / LEVEL OF DANGER

4. risk = how likely/severe an undesirable outcome is considered to be

“The risk is relatively low.”

「風險相對較低。」

Common:

- high risk
- low risk
- moderate risk
- serious risk
- significant risk

- unacceptable risk
-

5. risk increases / decreases

“Borrowing heavily increases the risk.”

「大量借貸會增加風險。」

6. reduce / lower risk

“Testing the café concept first can reduce risk.”

「先測試咖啡店概念可以降低風險。」

C. A RISK = A PARTICULAR DANGER

7. a risk = particular source or type of potential harm (危險因素)

“Fire is a major risk in this environment.”

「火災是這個環境中的重大風險因素。」

Countable here:

several risks.

8. health/safety/security risk

“Poor ventilation can be a health risk.”

「通風欠佳可能構成健康風險。」

D. AT RISK

9. at risk = exposed to possible harm/loss (處於風險中)

“The business is at risk.”

「這門生意面臨風險。」

10. put something at risk = endanger it (使.....陷入危險)

“Do not put your savings at risk unnecessarily.”

「不要不必要地令自己的積蓄承受風險。」

11. place X at risk

More formal:

“The delay placed the project at risk.”

「延誤令項目面臨風險。」

E. AT RISK OF

12. at risk of + noun/-ing = in danger of experiencing it

“The café is at risk of closing.”

「咖啡店有倒閉的風險。」

“He is at risk of losing his savings.”

「他有失去積蓄的風險。」

F. AT-RISK AS ADJECTIVE

13. at-risk + noun = especially vulnerable to an adverse outcome (高危／易受影響的)

Examples:

- at-risk students
- at-risk patients
- at-risk populations

The exact adverse outcome must come from context.

For example:

at-risk student

does not have one universal meaning; it may refer to elevated risk of:

- dropping out
- educational failure
- disengagement

depending on institution.

G. TAKE A RISK

14. take a risk = deliberately do something despite possible bad consequences (冒險)

Practice

“Opening a café means taking a risk.”

「開咖啡店意味着要承擔風險／冒險。」

15. take the risk

“She knew the business might fail but took the risk.”

「她知道生意可能失敗，但仍選擇冒這個險。」

H. RUN A RISK

16. run a risk = be exposed to a possibility of harm (冒.....風險)

“You run a serious risk if you open without enough capital.”

「如果資金不足便開業，你會冒很大的風險。」

I. RUN THE RISK OF

17. run the risk of doing X = expose oneself to possibility of X

“You run the risk of losing everything.”

「你可能會冒着失去一切的風險。」

Very common formal construction.

J. VERB: RISK + NOUN

18. risk something = expose something valuable to possible loss/damage (拿.....冒險)

“He risked his savings on the business.”

「他把自己的積蓄押上風險／拿去冒險。」

Common objects:

- life
 - money
 - career
 - reputation
 - health
 - safety
 - friendship
 - everything
-

K. RISK ONE'S LIFE

19. risk one's life = do something that may result in death (冒生命危險)

“Firefighters risk their lives.”

「消防員會冒生命危險執行工作。」

20. risk life and limb = 冒着生命和身體受傷的危險

Established idiom:

“There's no reason to risk life and limb.”

「沒有理由拿自己的性命和人身安全去冒險。」

L. RISK ONE'S NECK

**21. risk one's neck = take serious personal risk (冒大險)
— informal**

“I'm not risking my neck for that.”

「我不會為那件事拿自己安全冒險。」

Often physical, sometimes figurative.

M. VERB: RISK DOING SOMETHING

22. risk + -ing = do something that could result in an undesirable consequence

“If you quit immediately, you risk running out of money.”

「如果立即辭職，你可能會冒着耗盡資金的風險。」

Important grammar:

risk doing 

risk to do  in normal modern English.

23. risk losing

Extremely common:

risk losing customers

risk losing money

risk losing credibility.

24. risk being + adjective/participle

“You risk being misunderstood.”

「你可能會冒着被誤解的風險。」

N. RISK IT

25. risk it = proceed despite uncertainty/danger (冒險試一試)

“The weather looks bad, but let's risk it.”

「天氣看來不好，不過我們還是冒險試試吧。」

Here **it** refers broadly to:

taking the chance.

O. RISK EVERYTHING

26. risk everything = put everything important in danger

“He was unwilling to risk everything on an untested café.”

「他不願把一切都押在一間未經驗證的咖啡店上。」

Strong rhetorical phrase.

P. AT YOUR OWN RISK

27. at your own risk = accepting responsibility for possible harm/loss (風險自負)

“Use the equipment at your own risk.”

「使用設備風險自負。」

Often found in:

- warnings
- notices
- disclaimers

Its exact legal effect depends on context and applicable law; the phrase itself does not automatically eliminate legal responsibility.

Q. AT THE RISK OF...

28. at the risk of doing/sounding X = even though saying/doing this may cause an unwanted impression/result

A discourse-marker use.

“At the risk of sounding pessimistic, I think the budget is too small.”

「冒着聽起來過分悲觀的風險，我仍想說預算太少。」

More naturally:

「雖然這樣說可能顯得悲觀，但……」

No literal physical danger.

29. at the risk of repeating myself

“At the risk of repeating myself, preparation matters.”

「雖然可能又要重複一次，但準備真的很重要。」

Very common formal conversational phrase.

R. WORTH THE RISK

30. worth the risk = potential benefit justifies taking the risk(值得冒險)

“The opportunity may be worth the risk.”

「這個機會可能值得冒險。」

S. NOT WORTH THE RISK

31. not worth the risk = potential benefit does not justify danger

“Opening without savings is not worth the risk.”

「沒有積蓄便開店，這個風險並不值得承擔。」

T. CALCULATED RISK

32. calculated risk = risk taken after deliberate assessment(經過衡量的風險)

“Testing a pop-up first is a calculated risk.”

「先試辦快閃店是一種經過評估後承擔的風險。」

Important:

calculated does not mean:

mathematically exact.

It means:

consciously considered rather than reckless.

U. RISK-TAKING

33. risk-taking = willingness/behaviour of taking risks (冒險行為)

“Entrepreneurship often involves risk-taking.”

「創業往往涉及承擔風險／冒險行為。」

34. risk-taker = person willing to accept considerable risk (敢冒險的人)

“He's a natural risk-taker.”

「他天生是個敢冒險的人。」

Can be:

- praise
- criticism
- neutral description

depending on context.

V. RISKY

35. risky = involving significant possibility of harm/failure
(有風險的; 冒險的)

“Opening immediately would be risky.”

「立即開店會很冒險／風險很高。」

36. risky investment / strategy / move

Common:

- risky investment
 - risky business decision
 - risky strategy
 - risky behaviour
-

37. risky business

Can literally mean:

business activity involving substantial risk.

It can also be an informal phrase meaning:

a dangerous/unwise activity.

W. RISKY vs RISQUÉ

Critical spelling distinction.

risky

= dangerous / involving risk.

risqué

= slightly indecent, sexually suggestive, or daring in a social/moral sense.

risky investment = 高風險投資

risqué joke = 帶點色情／大膽的笑話

Completely different words.

X. RISKINESS

38. riskiness = degree/quality of being risky (風險程度)

“Investors disagreed about the riskiness of the project.”

「投資者對項目的風險程度看法不同。」

Y. HIGH-RISK / LOW-RISK

39. high-risk = having a relatively high chance/severity of adverse outcome (高風險的)

Examples:

- high-risk investment
- high-risk patient
- high-risk activity
- high-risk industry

The precise threshold depends on domain.

40. low-risk = relatively low risk (低風險的)

Important:

low-risk $\neq$ risk-free.

Z. RISK-FREE

41. risk-free = involving no relevant identified risk, or theoretically treated as having none of a specified kind

Everyday:

“No investment is completely risk-free.”

「沒有投資是完全零風險的。」

Finance has a more technical sense discussed below.

AA. BUSINESS RISK

42. business risk = uncertainty that affects business outcomes (商業風險)

Can include:

- demand changes
- competition
- costs
- operations
- regulation
- supply disruption

depending on framework.

43. commercial risk = 商業風險

Broadly similar, often emphasizing commercial transaction/market outcomes.

44. entrepreneurial risk = 創業風險

The uncertainty and potential losses involved in starting/running a venture.

Directly relevant to your passage.

AB. STRATEGIC RISK

45. strategic risk = risk arising from strategy or major strategic decisions (策略風險)

Examples may include:

- entering wrong market
- flawed business model
- unsuccessful acquisition

depending on organization.

AC. OPERATIONAL RISK

46. operational risk = risk arising from failures in processes, people, systems, or external events (營運風險)

You encountered **operational risk** under **operate**.

Common sources:

- system outage
- process failure
- human error
- fraud
- external disruption

Exact institutional definitions vary.

AD. PROJECT MANAGEMENT

47. project risk = uncertain event/condition that could affect project objectives (項目風險)

Could affect:

- cost
 - schedule
 - quality
 - scope
 - benefits
-

48. risk register = 風險登記冊

A project/governance document listing identified risks and relevant information such as:

- description
- probability
- impact
- owner

- response

depending on framework.

49. risk owner = person responsible for overseeing response to a particular risk (風險負責人)

Does not necessarily mean:

person who caused the risk.

50. risk response = 風險應對

Actions planned in response to risk.

51. risk mitigation = 風險緩解

Reduce:

- probability;
- impact;
- exposure,

depending on context.

52. risk avoidance = 風險規避

Do not undertake/remove the activity giving rise to the risk.

53. risk transfer = 風險轉移

Shift some financial/consequential responsibility to another party, for example through:

- insurance
- contract

depending on context.

Risk itself may not literally disappear.

54. risk acceptance = 風險接受

Consciously decide to retain the risk.

55. risk sharing = 風險分攤

Distribute consequences/exposure among several parties.

AE. RISK MANAGEMENT

56. risk management = systematic identification, assessment, and handling of risk (風險管理)

Broad field/process.

May include:

- identify
- assess

- prioritize
 - respond
 - monitor
-

57. enterprise risk management (ERM) = 企業全面風險管理

Organization-wide approach to managing interconnected risks.

AF. RISK ASSESSMENT

58. risk assessment = process of identifying/evaluating risk (風險評估)

Can be:

- qualitative
- quantitative
- semi-quantitative

depending on field.

59. risk analysis = 風險分析

Often part of risk assessment.

Exact distinctions among:

- risk identification
- risk analysis
- risk evaluation
- risk assessment

depend on framework.

60. risk evaluation = 風險評價

Comparison of analyzed risk with criteria/acceptable thresholds under a given framework.

AG. RISK MATRIX

61. risk matrix = matrix commonly combining likelihood and consequence categories (風險矩陣)

Often used to classify risks such as:

- low
- medium
- high

Exact design varies.

62. likelihood × consequence

Many practical frameworks characterize risk using some combination of:

likelihood and consequence/impact,

but there is no single universal mathematical definition of **risk** across every discipline.

AH. INHERENT / RESIDUAL RISK

63. inherent risk = risk before specified controls/mitigations (固有風險)

The precise definition varies by field.

64. residual risk = risk remaining after controls/mitigation (剩餘風險)

“Controls reduced, but did not eliminate, residual risk.”

「控制措施降低了風險，但仍存在剩餘風險。」

65. control risk

In auditing specifically, **control risk** has a formal technical meaning related to material misstatements not being prevented/detected/corrected by internal controls.

In broader risk-management speech, wording may differ.

AI. RISK APPETITE

66. risk appetite = amount/type of risk an organization is willing to pursue or retain (風險胃納／風險承受意願)

Formal risk-management term.

67. risk tolerance = acceptable degree of variation/exposure around objectives (風險容忍度)

Closely related but not identical to **risk appetite** in many frameworks.

Broad tendency:

- appetite = overall willingness
- tolerance = acceptable limits

Exact definitions vary by framework.

68. risk capacity = ability to absorb losses/risk (風險承受能力)

Especially finance.

Different from willingness:

can afford risk ≠ wants risk.

AJ. RISK PROFILE

69. risk profile = overall pattern/level/types of risk associated with a person, organization, investment, etc. (風險概況)

Can describe:

- investment risk
- medical risk

- corporate exposure
- cybersecurity posture

depending on context.

AK. RISK EXPOSURE

70. risk exposure = extent to which someone is subject to potential loss (風險暴露)

Business/finance/project term.

Often concerns:

- amount
- probability
- potential impact

depending on methodology.

AL. RISK INDICATOR

71. key risk indicator (KRI) = 主要風險指標

Metric monitored for signs of increasing exposure to a risk.

Different from:

KPI = key performance indicator.

AM. INSURANCE: RISK = POSSIBILITY OF INSURED LOSS

72. insurance risk = possibility of covered loss/event (保險風險)

Insurance fundamentally involves transferring/pooling specified financial risks under policy terms.

73. insured risk = 被承保風險

A particular peril/exposure covered according to the insurance contract.

AN. INSURANCE: RISK = PERSON / PROPERTY BEING INSURED

74. risk = person, property, or exposure considered for insurance (承保對象／風險標的)

A specialist industry sense.

“The insurer considered him a good risk.”

Approximately:

「保險公司認為他屬於風險較低的承保對象。」

Here **risk** refers to the person/exposure being underwritten.

75. good risk / bad risk

Insurance/credit-style terminology:

- good risk = relatively favourable exposure
- bad/poor risk = relatively unfavourable exposure

Context determines criteria.

**76. write a risk = insurer
accepts/underwrites that insurance
exposure**

Specialist insurance language.

AO. INSURABLE RISK

**77. insurable risk = risk suitable/eligible for insurance
under relevant underwriting principles (可保風險)**

Not every uncertain event is necessarily commercially or legally insurable.

78. uninsurable risk = 不可保風險

A risk an insurer will not/cannot cover under the relevant conditions.

AP. RISK POOL

**79. risk pool = group of exposures whose losses are
pooled/shared (風險池)**

Used in:

- insurance
 - healthcare financing
-

80. risk pooling = 風險共擔／風險匯集

Combining many exposures so losses can be shared across the pool.

AQ. UNDERWRITING / RISK CLASSIFICATION

81. risk classification = 風險分類

Grouping insureds/exposures according to expected risk characteristics.

82. risk selection = 風險選擇

Insurer chooses which risks to accept and on what terms.

AR. ALL-RISKS INSURANCE

83. all-risks cover/policy = broad insurance covering losses unless excluded, subject to wording

Despite the name:

all risks ≠ literally every possible loss

Coverage depends on policy terms/exclusions.

Traditional Chinese:

全險／一切險 depending on insurance market/context.

AS. FINANCE: RISK–RETURN TRADE-OFF

84. risk-return trade-off = relationship between expected return and risk (風險回報取舍)

General finance principle:

investors commonly require higher expected compensation for bearing greater relevant risk,

though realized returns are never guaranteed simply because something is riskier.

AT. MARKET RISK

85. market risk = potential loss from movements in market prices/rates (市場風險)

Can include exposure to changes in:

- equity prices
- interest rates
- foreign exchange
- commodities

depending on framework.

AU. CREDIT RISK

86. credit risk = risk that borrower/counterparty fails to meet financial obligations (信用風險)

borrower may default or deteriorate in creditworthiness.

AV. DEFAULT RISK

87. default risk = risk of failing to make required payments (違約風險)

A major component of credit risk.

AW. COUNTERPARTY RISK

88. counterparty risk = risk that the other party to a financial transaction fails to perform (交易對手風險)

Especially:

- derivatives
 - trading
 - settlement
-

AX. LIQUIDITY RISK

89. liquidity risk = risk of inability to transact/fund obligations without unacceptable loss or difficulty (流動性風險)

Two broad forms often distinguished:

- market liquidity risk
 - funding liquidity risk.
-

AY. INTEREST-RATE RISK

90. interest-rate risk = risk arising from changes in interest rates (利率風險)

Can affect:

- bond prices
 - funding costs
 - cash flows
 - valuation
-

AZ. CURRENCY / FX RISK

91. currency risk / foreign-exchange risk = 外匯風險

Potential losses/value changes from exchange-rate movement.

BA. INFLATION RISK

92. inflation risk = risk that inflation erodes real value/purchasing power (通脹風險)

Links to your previous **erode** family.

BB. REINVESTMENT RISK

93. reinvestment risk = risk future cash flows must be reinvested at less favourable rates (再投資風險)

Especially fixed-income investing.

BC. CONCENTRATION RISK

94. concentration risk = excessive exposure to one borrower, sector, asset, geography, etc. (集中風險)

A lack of diversification can increase concentration risk.

BD. COUNTRY / SOVEREIGN RISK

95. country risk = financial/business risk associated with conditions in a particular country (國家風險)

Can include economic, legal, transfer, and institutional conditions depending on analysis.

96. sovereign risk = risk associated with sovereign-government obligations/actions (主權風險)

Often especially related to sovereign debt or government capacity/willingness to meet obligations.

BE. SYSTEMATIC vs IDIOSYNCRATIC RISK

97. systematic risk = broad market-wide risk not removable through ordinary diversification (系統性市場風險)

Often associated with macro/market factors.

98. idiosyncratic risk / specific risk = risk specific to a company/asset (特定風險)

May be reduced substantially through diversification in standard portfolio theory.

BF. SYSTEMIC RISK

99. systemic risk = risk of disruption spreading through an interconnected financial/system network (系統性風險)

Important:

systemic risk $\neq$ systematic risk

systematic

market-wide factor risk in portfolio finance.

systemic

risk that distress propagates through/interferes with an entire system.

Very important distinction.

BG. RISK PREMIUM

100. risk premium = extra expected return/compensation demanded for bearing risk (風險溢價)

Broadly:

expected return on risky asset – relevant risk-free benchmark,

depending on context.

Different finance models define specific risk premia differently.

BH. RISK-FREE RATE

101. risk-free rate = theoretical/reference return on an asset treated as free of specified default risk (無風險利率)

In finance models, “risk-free” is an idealized/reference concept.

No real-world asset is necessarily literally free of every imaginable form of risk.

BI. RISK-ADJUSTED RETURN

102. risk-adjusted return = investment performance assessed relative to risk taken (風險調整後回報)

Different metrics use different concepts of risk.

BJ. RISK-ADJUSTED

103. risk-adjusted = modified/interpreted after accounting for risk

Examples:

- risk-adjusted return
 - risk-adjusted performance
 - risk-adjusted capital
-

BK. VALUE AT RISK

104. Value at Risk (VaR) = model-based loss threshold associated with a chosen probability and horizon (風險價值)

Broadly, VaR estimates a loss level that is not expected to be exceeded with a stated confidence/probability over a specified horizon under the model.

Example structure:

one-day 99% VaR

cannot be interpreted without both:

- horizon
- confidence level.

VaR does not describe the size of losses beyond that threshold.

BL. EXPECTED SHORTFALL

105. expected shortfall = expected loss conditional on being in the tail beyond a specified threshold (預期短缺／預期損失)

Often used as an alternative/complement to VaR in financial risk management.

It is a risk measure rather than a lexical sense of **risk**, but belongs in the risk-measure family.

BM. RISK BUDGET

106. risk budget = allocated amount of permitted risk exposure (風險預算)

Portfolio/institutional risk-management term.

BN. RISK PARITY

107. risk parity = portfolio approach allocating exposures according to risk contributions (風險平價)

Rather than allocating solely by money invested.

Specialist finance.

BO. RISK-ON / RISK-OFF

108. risk-on = market environment where investors show greater appetite for risky assets

risk-on sentiment

≈ 風險偏好上升

109. risk-off = environment where investors prefer relatively safer assets

≈ 避險情緒／風險偏好下降

Financial-market shorthand.

These labels are simplifications, not precise universal classifications.

BP. RISK CAPITAL

110. risk capital = capital deliberately exposed to significant loss risk in pursuit of return (風險資本)

Often associated with:

- equity investment
- venture capital
- speculative investment

depending on context.

BQ. CAPITAL AT RISK

111. capital at risk = invested principal can potentially be lost

Common investment warning:

“Your capital is at risk.”

「你的投資本金可能蒙受損失。」

BR. RISK AVERSION

112. risk aversion = preference for less risk, all else equal
(風險厭惡)

Economics/finance/decision theory.

A risk-averse person generally requires compensation for accepting additional uncertainty under the model.

BS. RISK-AVERSE

113. risk-averse = reluctant to accept risk (風險厭惡的／偏保守的)

“The investor is highly risk-averse.”

「這名投資者非常抗拒風險。」

BT. RISK-NEUTRAL

114. risk-neutral = indifferent to risk as such under a specified decision model (風險中性)

In basic expected-value theory:

choices depend on expected outcome, not additional preference/dislike for dispersion itself.

In mathematical finance, **risk-neutral probability/measure** has a much more technical meaning and should not be interpreted as saying actual investors literally do not care about risk.

BU. RISK-SEEKING / RISK-LOVING

115. risk-seeking = preferring riskier alternatives under relevant conditions (風險偏好)

Also:

- risk-loving

Used in behavioral/economic decision theory.

BV. DECISION THEORY

116. risk = uncertainty where outcomes/probabilities are represented or estimated

Some economics/decision-theory traditions distinguish:

- **risk**: probabilities are known/quantifiable;
- **uncertainty**: probabilities are not known.

But everyday English and many professional disciplines do **not** consistently maintain this strict distinction.

BW. MEDICINE: MEDICAL RISK

117. risk = probability/chance of an adverse health outcome (健康／醫療風險)

“The medicine may increase the risk of bleeding.”

「這種藥可能增加出血風險。」

Medical use often requires specifying:

- population
 - timeframe
 - outcome.
-

BX. RISK FACTOR

118. risk factor = characteristic/exposure associated with higher probability of an outcome (風險因素)

Examples may include:

- age
- behavior
- medical condition
- environmental exposure

depending on disease/outcome.

Important:

risk factor ≠ necessarily proven direct cause.

It can be statistically associated with increased risk.

BY. PROTECTIVE FACTOR

Contrast:

risk factor

associated with higher risk.

protective factor

associated with lower risk or resilience.

BZ. HIGH-RISK PATIENT

119. high-risk patient = patient assessed as having elevated probability of a specified adverse outcome

The relevant outcome might be:

- surgical complication
- infection
- disease
- deterioration

depending on context.

“High risk” is incomplete without knowing **risk of what**.

CA. RISK STRATIFICATION

120. risk stratification = grouping people into categories according to estimated risk (風險分層)

Used in:

- medicine
 - public health
 - insurance
-

CB. ABSOLUTE RISK

121. absolute risk = probability of an outcome in a specified group over a specified time (絕對風險)

Example conceptually:

2 people out of 100 over five years → 2% five-year absolute risk.

The population and time horizon matter.

CC. RELATIVE RISK / RISK RATIO

122. relative risk / risk ratio = risk in one group divided by risk in another (相對風險／風險比)

Example:

4% vs 2% → risk ratio 2.0.

This means twice the risk, not:

a 2-percentage-point absolute increase only.

CD. ABSOLUTE RISK INCREASE / REDUCTION

123. absolute risk increase = difference in absolute risk between groups (絕對風險增加)

124. absolute risk reduction = 絕對風險降低

Important when interpreting treatment effects.

CE. RELATIVE RISK REDUCTION

125. relative risk reduction = proportional reduction relative to comparison risk

A treatment may have:

- large relative reduction
- small absolute reduction

if baseline risk is low.

Therefore the two measures should not be confused.

CF. BASELINE RISK

126. baseline risk = underlying/reference risk before specified intervention/exposure (基線風險)

Crucial for interpreting relative effects.

CG. LIFETIME RISK

127. lifetime risk = probability of developing/experiencing outcome over remaining lifetime under specified assumptions (終身風險)

Population estimates depend on:

- age
- sex
- competing risks
- population data

and other assumptions.

CH. ATTRIBUTABLE RISK

128. attributable risk = excess risk associated with an exposure under specified epidemiological framing (歸因風險)

Definitions/formulas can vary in presentation, but often refers to difference in incidence/risk between exposed and unexposed groups.

Specialist epidemiology.

CI. POPULATION ATTRIBUTABLE RISK

129. population attributable risk = excess disease burden in population associated with exposure under causal assumptions

Specialist public health.

CJ. ODDS vs RISK

Important distinction.

risk/probability

probability of event among total possible outcomes.

odds

event probability relative to non-event probability.

Example:

risk 20% = 0.20

odds:

$0.20 / 0.80 = 0.25.$

They are not numerically identical except approximately when the event is rare.

CK. ODDS RATIO vs RISK RATIO

risk ratio

compares risks/probabilities.

odds ratio

compares odds.

They should not be casually treated as the same measure.

CL. HAZARD vs RISK — EPIDEMIOLOGY

risk

probability of experiencing event over a period.

hazard

instantaneous event rate/intensity conditional on having not yet experienced the event, under survival-analysis concepts.

Thus:

hazard ratio $\neq$ risk ratio.

CM. HAZARD vs RISK — SAFETY

A different distinction:

hazard

source/situation with potential to cause harm.

risk

combination/concept involving likelihood and consequences of that harm.

Example:

exposed electrical wire = hazard
chance/severity of someone being injured = risk.

This distinction is foundational in occupational safety, though exact definitions vary by standard.

CN. BENEFIT–RISK / RISK–BENEFIT

130. risk-benefit analysis = comparison of potential harms and benefits (風險—效益分析)

Common in:

- medicine
- public health
- engineering
- business decisions

131. benefit-risk balance = 效益與風險的平衡

Especially medicine/regulation.

CO. SAFETY / ENGINEERING RISK

132. safety risk = possibility of injury/damage due to hazards (安全風險)

133. risk assessment — engineering/safety

May examine:

- hazard identification
 - likelihood
 - severity/consequence
 - existing controls
-

134. risk control = measures reducing risk (風險控制)

Can include:

- elimination
- substitution

- engineering controls
- administrative controls
- protective equipment

depending on safety framework.

135. risk reduction = 風險降低

General outcome of controls/mitigation.

CP. RISK PRIORITY NUMBER

136. risk priority number (RPN) = numerical prioritization measure used in some FMEA approaches

Traditionally calculated from ratings such as:

- severity
- occurrence
- detection

under a specific FMEA scheme.

It is a prioritization aid, not a universal measure of “true risk.”

CQ. CYBERSECURITY

137. cyber risk = possibility of loss/disruption arising from cyber threats/vulnerabilities (網絡風險)

Potential consequences may include:

- data loss
 - service disruption
 - financial loss
 - unauthorized access
-

CR. SECURITY RISK

138. security risk = source/exposure that could compromise security

Can refer to:

- situation
- person
- vulnerability
- activity

depending on context.

“An unpatched server is a security risk.”

「未修補漏洞的伺服器構成安全風險。」

CS. THREAT / VULNERABILITY / RISK

Very important in cybersecurity.

threat

potential cause/actor/event capable of harm.

vulnerability

weakness that can be exploited.

risk

potential adverse consequence arising when threats interact with vulnerabilities/assets.

Different frameworks formalize these relationships differently.

CT. PRIVACY RISK

139. privacy risk = possibility of harm arising from collection/use/disclosure of personal data (私隱風險)

Can involve:

- re-identification
- unauthorized disclosure
- inappropriate use
- surveillance impacts

depending on context.

CU. DATA RISK

140. data risk = risk associated with loss, corruption, misuse, unauthorized access, etc.

Broad technology/governance term.

CV. SUPPLY-CHAIN RISK

141. supply-chain risk = possibility of disruption/loss in supply network (供應鏈風險)

Examples:

- supplier failure
 - delay
 - transport disruption
 - shortage
-

CW. REPUTATIONAL RISK

142. reputational risk = risk of harm to reputation and resulting consequences (聲譽風險)

Can affect:

- trust
 - customer behavior
 - partnerships
 - valuation
-

CX. COMPLIANCE RISK

143. compliance risk = risk arising from failure to comply with laws/rules/standards (合規風險)

Exact scope depends on organization and regulatory environment.

CY. LEGAL RISK

144. legal risk = exposure to loss/adverse outcomes through legal obligations, disputes, uncertainty, etc. (法律風險)

Broad professional term.

CZ. ASSUMPTION OF RISK — LAW

145. assumption of risk = legal doctrine/concept that a person knowingly accepted certain risks

Common-law terminology in some jurisdictions.

Its effect and requirements vary substantially by jurisdiction and context.

繁體中文: often 自願承擔風險／風險承擔抗辯

DA. RISK OF LOSS — CONTRACT / PROPERTY

146. risk of loss = responsibility for financial loss if goods/property are damaged/destroyed (滅失風險)

Contract/property/commercial-law term.

Rules about when risk passes depend on applicable law/contract.

DB. RISK ALLOCATION

147. risk allocation = contractual/economic assignment of responsibility for specified risks (風險分配)

Examples:

- indemnity
- insurance
- price adjustment
- warranties

depending on transaction.

DC. RISK TRANSFER

148. risk transfer = shifting financial consequences to another party

Insurance is a common example, but not the only one.

Important:

transfer of financial responsibility $\neq$ elimination of underlying hazard.

DD. MORAL HAZARD — RELATED BUT DISTINCT

Moral hazard is not a meaning of **risk**, but highly relevant in insurance.

It concerns changes in behavior/incentives when someone is insulated from consequences of risk.

Do not confuse:

hazard
moral hazard
risk.

DE. RISK COMMUNICATION

149. risk communication = communication about hazards, probabilities, uncertainty, and protective actions (風險溝通)

Used in:

- medicine
 - public health
 - safety
 - emergency management
-

DF. PERCEIVED RISK

150. perceived risk = how risky someone believes something to be (感知風險)

May differ from statistical/modelled risk.

DG. OBJECTIVE vs SUBJECTIVE RISK

Some fields distinguish:

objective/modelled risk

estimated from data/model.

perceived/subjective risk

person's own belief/feeling about risk.

Terminology varies.

DH. RISK COMPENSATION

151. risk compensation = tendency to adjust behavior in response to perceived safety/risk

A behavioral concept:

people may behave more cautiously when they feel vulnerable or less cautiously when they feel protected.

Its empirical importance varies by domain/context.

DI. DE-RISK / DERISK

152. de-risk = reduce exposure to risk (降低風險)

Modern business/finance/technology verb.

“The company is trying to de-risk the launch.”

「公司正嘗試降低產品推出的風險。」

153. de-risk an investment/project

May involve:

- testing
- diversification
- contracts
- insurance
- staged investment

depending on context.

154. de-risking = process of reducing risk exposure (去風險／降低風險)

Widely used in:

- banking
 - investment
 - supply chains
 - projects
 - strategy
-

155. banking de-risking

In financial-compliance contexts, **de-risking** can specifically mean terminating/restricting relationships with customers/categories considered too risky rather than managing individual risks.

That is a specialized institutional sense.

DJ. RISK-BASED

156. risk-based = decisions/priorities determined according to assessed risk (以風險為本的)

Examples:

- risk-based approach
- risk-based regulation
- risk-based inspection
- risk-based authentication

Meaning:

higher-risk cases generally receive different/more intensive treatment.

DK. RISK-SENSITIVE

157. risk-sensitive = responsive to differences in risk (風險敏感的)

Used in:

- finance
- regulation
- control theory
- planning

DL. RISK-BEARING

158. risk-bearing = assuming/exposed to risk (承擔風險的)

risk-bearing capacity

= 風險承擔能力

DM. RISK SHARING

159. risk-sharing arrangement = arrangement dividing financial/operational risk among parties

Common in:

- partnerships
- insurance
- healthcare contracts
- financing

DN. FIXED EXPRESSIONS / PROVERBS

160. no risk, no reward = without accepting some risk, substantial reward may be impossible

A common saying.

繁體中文:「不冒險, 難有回報」roughly.

It is motivational, not a literal law of finance.

161. nothing ventured, nothing gained

Not using the word **risk**, but semantically close:

no attempt/risk → no gain.

162. take no chances / take no risks

“She takes no risks with food safety.”

「她在食品安全方面絕不冒險。」

163. a risk worth taking

“It may be a risk worth taking.”

「這可能是個值得承擔的風險。」

DO. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

risk vs danger

danger

condition/threat capable of causing harm.

risk

possibility/degree of harm occurring.

climbing near a cliff may be dangerous
the risk of falling depends on conditions.

risk vs hazard

As above:

hazard

source of potential harm.

risk

likelihood/consequence of harm from exposure.

They overlap more loosely in everyday English.

risk vs threat

threat

something capable of causing harm, often external or intentional.

risk

possibility of undesirable consequences.

A threat contributes to risk.

risk vs uncertainty

uncertainty

lack of certainty about what will happen.

risk

uncertainty specifically involving potentially undesirable consequences, often assessed more concretely.

Some decision theories use stricter technical distinctions.

risk vs chance

chance

neutral probability/opportunity.

risk

normally emphasizes possible negative outcome.

Compare:

chance of success
risk of failure.

But everyday English can say:

chance of rain

without positive meaning.

risk vs probability

probability

numerical/conceptual likelihood of an event.

risk

may include probability **plus seriousness of consequences**.

Thus two events can have equal probability but very different risk if consequences differ.

risk vs likelihood

likelihood

how probable something is.

risk

usually additionally concerns adverse outcome and sometimes impact.

risk vs consequence

consequence

what happens if event occurs.

risk

concerns possibility/exposure to that consequence.

risk vs exposure

exposure

extent to which person/entity is subjected to a source of risk.

risk

overall potential adverse outcome.

High exposure often raises risk but is not identical.

risk vs vulnerability

vulnerability

susceptibility/weakness.

risk

possible harm arising from threat + vulnerability + exposure and other factors depending on framework.

risk vs gamble

Very relevant to your passage.

risk

any exposure to uncertain negative consequences.

gamble

deliberately stake something on uncertain outcome, often with greater emphasis on chance/speculation.

Every business involves risk; not every business decision is reasonably described as gambling.

The passage later says:

“instead of **gambling your future** on wishful thinking”

which is deliberately harsher than merely:

taking a risk.

risk vs recklessness

risk-taking

can be rational/calculated.

recklessness

disregard of serious/obvious risk.

The letter encourages:

calculated risk

but rejects:

reckless resignation.

risk vs adventure

adventure

exciting/unusual experience, often involving uncertainty.

risk

focuses specifically on possible harm/loss.

risky vs dangerous

risky

contains a meaningful possibility of harm/failure.

dangerous

more directly capable of causing harm.

risky investment
dangerous chemical.

risk-free vs safe

risk-free

no relevant risk under stated assumptions.

safe

acceptably protected from harm.

Something can be considered safe without literally having zero risk.

risk tolerance vs risk capacity

tolerance

how much risk someone is willing/comfortable to accept.

capacity

how much loss/risk they can financially/operationally withstand.

A person may tolerate high risk psychologically but have low financial capacity.

risk appetite vs risk tolerance

As above:

appetite

broad desired/willing level/type of risk.

tolerance

acceptable variation or limit.

Framework definitions vary.

risk management vs risk elimination

Risk management does **not** necessarily mean removing all risk.

Many activities involve:

identify → reduce → transfer → accept.

risk mitigation vs risk avoidance

mitigate

reduce risk.

avoid

stop/remove the activity/exposure altogether.

risk transfer vs risk sharing

transfer

shift consequences/responsibility substantially to another party.

sharing

multiple parties retain parts of the risk.

DP. GRAMMAR

164. risk + noun

risk your savings
risk your reputation
risk your life

165. risk + -ing

risk losing money
risk upsetting customers.

166. risk of + noun/-ing

risk of failure
risk of losing money.

167. risk that + clause

risk that demand may fall.

168. at risk

business is at risk.

169. at risk of + -ing

at risk of closing.

170. put/place X at risk

put savings at risk.

171. risk X on Y

“He risked his savings on the venture.”

Possible, emphasizing what is staked.

DQ. COUNTABILITY

risk = general concept

Often uncountable:

business involves risk
reduce risk.

a risk = particular danger

Countable:

a major risk
several risks.

risks = types/sources of risk

financial and operational risks.

riskiness

Usually uncountable:

the riskiness of the investment.

DR. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch

Main meaning

risk — general noun	possibility of harm, failure, or loss
a risk	particular danger/source of potential harm
risk — verb	expose something to potential loss
risk doing	do something despite possible negative consequence
risky	involving meaningful risk
riskiness	degree of risk
at-risk	unusually vulnerable to a specified adverse outcome
risk-free	free of the specified relevant risk / theoretical finance concept

risk-based	governed/prioritized according to risk assessment
risk-adjusted	measured after accounting for risk
risk-averse	preferring less risk
risk-neutral	indifferent to risk under a specified model
risk-seeking	preferring greater risk under specified conditions
risk-taking	behavior of accepting risk
risk-taker	person inclined to accept risk
de-risk	reduce exposure to risk
de-risking	process/practice of reducing or shedding risk

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
risk — general	某種不利結果可能發生的風險
a risk	某一個具體危險因素／風險來源
risk of X	X 發生的可能風險
risk that...	某不利情況可能出現
at risk	暴露於可能受到損失／傷害的狀態
at risk of X	有發生 X 的風險
put X at risk	使 X 暴露在可能損失／傷害之下
at-risk person/group	較容易出現某指定不良結果的人／群體
take a risk	明知存在不良後果可能仍決定去做；冒險
run the risk of	面臨／冒着某不利結果發生的風險
risk something	把金錢、生命、聲譽等置於可能損失的情況

risk doing X	做某事而可能因此產生不良後果
risk one's life	冒生命危險
risk it	明知不確定仍決定冒險試一試
at your own risk	自行承擔可能後果；風險自負
at the risk of sounding X	雖然這樣說可能給人某種負面印象
calculated risk	經過衡量後有意承擔的風險
worth the risk	潛在回報值得承擔相關風險
risky	具有較明顯失敗／受損可能性的
riskiness	某事的風險程度
high-risk / low-risk	相對高／低風險的
risk-free	沒有指定相關風險；金融中常是理論／基準概念
business/entrepreneurial risk	經營／創業中因需求、成本、競爭等不確定性產生的損失風險
strategic risk	重大策略選擇／方向錯誤造成的風險
operational risk	人員、流程、系統或外部事件導致的營運風險
project risk	可能影響項目成本、進度、品質、範圍等的的不確定事件
risk register	記錄已識別風險、影響、負責人和應對措施的風險登記冊
risk owner	負責監察／管理某項風險的人
risk mitigation	降低風險發生可能性／影響的措施
risk avoidance	停止或不進行產生風險的活動
risk transfer	把部分財務後果／責任轉移給另一方
risk acceptance	明確認知後決定保留／承擔風險
risk management	識別、評估、應對、監察風險的系統化過程

risk assessment	識別和評估風險程度的過程
risk matrix	以可能性和後果等分類風險的矩陣
inherent risk	未計入特定控制措施前的固有風險
residual risk	控制／緩解後仍然存在的剩餘風險
risk appetite	機構願意主動追求或承受的整體風險程度／種類
risk tolerance	可接受的風險變動／上限
risk capacity	實際有能力承受損失的程度
risk profile	某人／企業／投資整體風險特徵
risk exposure	暴露於某項潛在損失的程度
insurance risk	保險合約所涉及的損失事件風險
risk — insurance subject	被保險公司評估、承保的人／物／暴露
insurable risk	符合相關條件、可以接受承保的風險
risk pool	把大量風險集中並共同分攤損失的風險池
market risk	市場價格、利率、匯率等變動造成的風險
credit risk	借款人／對手方不能履行財務義務的風險
default risk	未能按約付款／履約的違約風險
counterparty risk	交易對手不能履行交易義務的風險
liquidity risk	難以及時交易／融資而造成損失的風險
interest-rate risk	利率變動造成價值／現金流變化的風險
currency risk	匯率變動造成的外匯風險
inflation risk	通脹侵蝕實質購買力／回報的風險
reinvestment risk	未來現金流需以較差條件重新投資的風險

concentration risk	過度集中於單一資產、客戶、行業等的風險
systematic risk	廣泛市場因素造成、一般難靠分散投資消除的風險
idiosyncratic risk	個別企業／資產特有的風險
systemic risk	風險在互相連結的整個系統內傳播並造成廣泛失效的風險
risk premium	承受額外風險所要求的額外預期回報
risk-free rate	金融模型中作為近似無指定風險基準的回報率
risk-adjusted return	把承擔的風險納入比較後衡量的投資回報
Value at Risk (VaR)	在指定時間與概率／信心水準下的模型化損失門檻
risk-on / risk-off	市場風險偏好上升／避險偏好上升的簡稱
risk capital	投入高不確定性、可能蒙受重大損失的資本
risk aversion	對額外不確定損失的抗拒／風險厭惡
risk-averse	傾向選擇較低風險的
risk-neutral	在指定模型中不因風險本身而改變偏好的
risk-seeking	在指定條件下偏好更高風險的
medical risk	在指定期間／群體出現某健康不良結果的概率
risk factor	與某不良結果風險增加相關的特徵／暴露；不一定證明直接因果
risk stratification	按估計風險把患者／人口分層
absolute risk	指定群體在指定期間出現結果的實際概率
relative risk / risk ratio	一組風險除以另一組風險所得的比率
baseline risk	未施加指定介入／比較前的基線風險
lifetime risk	在剩餘一生中出現某結果的估計概率
attributable risk	暴露組相對非暴露組增加的風險；專門流行病學概念

risk vs odds	risk 是事件概率; odds 是事件概率與非事件概率之比
risk vs hazard — epidemiology	risk 是一段期間的事件概率; hazard 是存活／未發生事件條件下的瞬時發生率概念
risk vs hazard — safety	hazard 是潛在危害來源; risk 是危害真正造成後果的可能性／嚴重程度概念
risk-benefit analysis	系統比較潛在風險與效益
cyber/security risk	網絡／資訊系統受到攻擊、損失、停機等的風險
privacy risk	個人資料收集、使用、披露等帶來的潛在損害
supply-chain risk	供應商、物流、短缺等造成供應鏈中斷的風險
reputational risk	聲譽受損及其後續影響的風險
compliance risk	不符合法律、規則或標準造成的風險
assumption of risk — law	某人明知特定風險仍自願承擔的法律概念; 效力依司法地區
risk of loss — law	貨物／財產損毀時由誰承擔經濟損失的法律風險
risk allocation	透過合約等方式分配各方承擔的風險
perceived risk	人主觀認為某件事有多危險
risk communication	向人說明風險、概率、不確定性及防護措施
de-risk	透過測試、分散、控制等降低風險暴露
de-risking	系統地減低／退出高風險暴露的過程
risk-based	根據風險高低分配決策、監管或資源的
risk-taking	願意接受可能負面結果的冒險行為
risk-taker	相對願意承擔風險的人

For your original passage

“...a café dream shared with friends, full of freedom, **risk** and possibility.”

The exact meaning is:

risk = opening the café could fail or produce negative consequences, particularly financial loss, lost income, debt, damaged friendships, or career disruption.

The passage carefully distinguishes three levels:

risk
something may go wrong.

calculated risk
you have researched, tested, saved money, and knowingly accept the remaining uncertainty.

gamble
you stake your future on insufficient evidence and wishful thinking.

That distinction is central to the advice letter. The writer is **not** saying Kam Chai should avoid all risk. Entrepreneurship inherently involves uncertainty. The recommendation is to turn an unnecessarily large, poorly understood risk into a **smaller, better-understood, consciously managed risk**.

For your core database, I would keep **7 principal semantic branches**:

1. **possibility/degree of harm, loss, or failure**
2. **a particular source of danger — a risk**
3. **verb: expose something valuable to possible loss**
4. **verb: do something despite a possible adverse result — risk doing**
5. **business/insurance/finance risk and quantified risk management**
6. **medical/epidemiological probability of adverse outcome**
7. **technical safety/security/project risk — assessed exposure to hazards, threats, or failure**

Then separately index the strongly lexicalized network **at risk, risk factor, calculated risk, risk appetite, risk tolerance, risk premium, risk-free, risk-adjusted, risk-on/risk-off, relative risk, risk ratio, risk assessment, risk register, risk management, de-risk**, because these meanings cannot safely be compressed into the single gloss 「風險」.